Present simple and continuous

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Use the present simple for habits and facts (hábitos y verdades)
- Use the present continuous for actions happening now (ahora mismo)
- Make negatives and questions with do/does and am/is/are
- Choose the right tense with time words: every day, now, at the moment

Para pensar

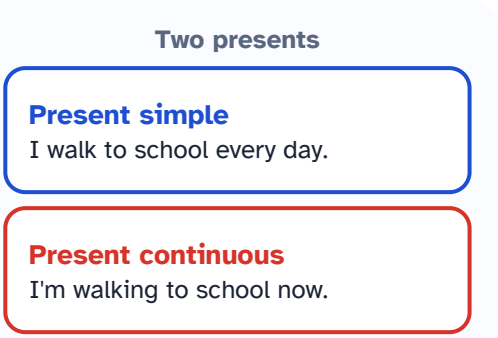
«I play football» y «I'm playing football» se traducen casi igual: «juego al fútbol» y «estoy jugando al fútbol». ¿Cuándo usarías cada una?

Explicación

Two presents

English has two present tenses. The **present simple** is for things we do **often** or things that are **always true**: «I **walk** to school every day», «Water **boils** at 100 °C». The **present continuous** is for things that are happening **now**: «Look! It's **raining**».

En castellano: el presente simple sirve para rutinas y verdades; el presente continuo, para lo que está pasando en este momento. En español también tenemos las dos formas («leo» y «estoy leyendo»), pero en inglés hay que elegir con más cuidado.



Present simple: affirmative

To make the present simple, use the verb without *to*: «I **play**», «you **play**», «we **play**», «they **play**». With **he, she** and **it** add -s: «she **plays**», «it **rains**».

Spelling (ortografía): verbs ending in -sh, -ch, -ss, -x and -o add **-es**: watch → watch**es**, go → go**es**, do → do**es**. Consonant + y changes to **-ies**: study → stud**ies**, fly → fl**ies**. But vowel + y only adds -s: play → plays. **Have** is irregular: he **has**.

Verb	He / She / It
play	plays
watch	watches
study	studies
have	has

Present simple: negatives and questions

For negatives we use don't (do not) or doesn't (does not) + verb: «I **don't like** fish», «He **doesn't like** fish». Careful: after *doesn't* the verb has no -s.

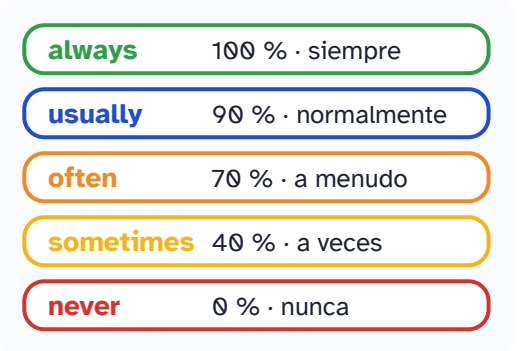
For questions we put **Do** or **Does** first: «**Do** you **like** pizza?» – «Yes, I do. / No, I don't». «**Does** she **speak** French?» – «Yes, she does. / No, she doesn't». **En castellano:** en inglés la pregunta no se hace solo con la entonación, como en «¿te gusta la pizza?»; necesita el ayudante *do/does*.



Time words for the present simple

Some words tell us to use the present simple. They are **frequency adverbs** (adverbios de frecuencia): always, usually, often, sometimes, never. They go **before** the main verb but **after** the verb *to be*: «I **usually** have cereal», «She is **always** happy».

Other time expressions go at the end: **every day**, **every Monday**, **on Saturdays**, **at the weekend**, **once a week**. Example: «We go swimming **twice a week**». **En castellano:** «twice a week» es «dos veces por semana».



Present continuous: form

The present continuous has two parts: the verb to be (am / is / are) and the verb with -ing. «I **am reading**», «She **is eating**», «They **are playing**». In speaking we use short forms: I'm, she's, they're.

Spelling: verbs ending in -e lose the e: write → writ**ing**, dance → danc**ing**. Short verbs ending in consonant + vowel + consonant double the last letter: swim → swi**mm**ing, run → ru**nn**ing, sit → si**tt**ing. Negative: «I'**m not** sleeping». Question: «**Are** you listening?» – «Yes, I am».



Time words for the present continuous

These words tell us that something is happening **now**: now, right now, at the moment, today, this week, and also **Look!** and **Listen!** «Look! The baby **is walking**!», «Be quiet! Grandpa **is sleeping**».

We also use the present continuous for **temporary** things (cosas temporales): «I usually live in Madrid, but this month I'**m staying** with my aunt in Cádiz». **En castellano:** si algo pasa solo durante un tiempo, aunque no sea en este segundo exacto, también va en continuo.



Simple or continuous?

Compare: «My dad **works** in a hospital» (that is his job, always) and «My dad **is working** in the garden» (now, at this moment). «Sara **speaks** English» (she can, always) and «Sara **is speaking** English» (now, on the phone).

Some verbs are almost never in continuous: like, love, hate, want, know, understand, need. We say «I **know** the answer», not «I'm knowing». **En castellano:** son verbos de gustos, deseos y pensamientos; no son acciones que se ven, por eso van en simple.

Always	Now
He works.	He's working.
She speaks.	She's speaking.
We play.	We're playing.

Reading: a day at summer camp

Read Marta's message: «Hi Grandma! I'm at summer camp. Every day I **get up** at eight and I **have** breakfast with my friends. We usually **go** canoeing in the morning. I **don't like** the food very much, but the activities are fantastic! Right now I'**m sitting** by the lake and my friends **are playing** volleyball. The sun **is shining**. Love, Marta».

Find the two presents: the routine (get up, have, go, don't like) and the things happening now (am sitting, are playing, is shining).

Every day	I get up at eight.
Usually	We go canoeing.
Right now	I'm sitting by the lake.
Now	The sun is shining.

Let's practise: picture game

Play in pairs. One student mimes an action (hace mímica) and the other asks: «**Are you swimming?**» – «No, I'm not». «**Are you dancing?**» – «Yes, I am!». Then change roles.

Second round: talk about your routine. «**Do you** walk to school?», «**What time do you** go to bed?», «**How often do you** play video games?». Answer with full sentences: «I sometimes play at the weekend». **Consejo:** escucha si la pregunta empieza por *Are* (ahora) o por *Do* (normalmente).

Question	Answer
Are you dancing?	Yes, I am.
Do you dance?	Yes, I do.
Is he eating?	No, he isn't.
Does he eat fish?	No, he doesn't.

Present simple and continuous



Ejercicios

1. **Write the he/she form: go, fly, wash, have.**

2. **Write the -ing form: write, swim, play, sit.**

3. **Make it negative: «Tom likes carrots.»**

4. **Make a question: «They live in Seville.»**

5. **Complete: «Look! The cat (climb) ___ the tree.»**

6. **Complete: «We (have) ___ English on Mondays.»**

7. **Put the adverb in the right place: «I am late. (never)»**

8. **Correct the mistake: «She is knowing the answer.»**

9. **Translate: «Normalmente voy en bici, pero hoy estoy caminando.»**

10. **Write two sentences about you: one routine and one thing you are doing now.**

Practica

1. **«She ___ to school by bus.» (every day)**
   - **A)** go
   - **B)** goes
   - **C)** is go
2. **«Look! It ___.»**
   - **A)** snows
   - **B)** snowing
   - **C)** is snowing
3. **The -ing form of «run» is...**
   - **A)** running
   - **B)** runing
   - **C)** runeing
4. **«___ you like chocolate?»**
   - **A)** Are
   - **B)** Does
   - **C)** Do
5. **«He ___ like spiders.»**
   - **A)** don't
   - **B)** doesn't
   - **C)** isn't
6. **Which word goes with the present continuous?**
   - **A)** at the moment
   - **B)** every day
   - **C)** usually
7. **«I ___ the answer.»**
   - **A)** am knowing
   - **B)** know
   - **C)** knowing
8. **The he/she form of «study» is...**
   - **A)** studys

B) studyes

C) studies

9. **«They ___ football now.»**

A) are playing

B) play

C) is playing

10. **Where does «always» go? «I ___ breakfast.»**

A) have always

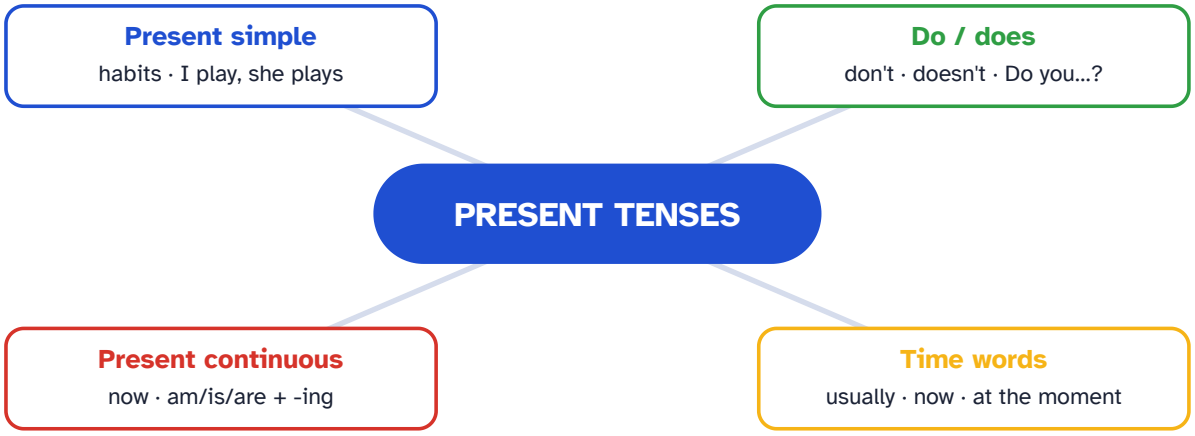
B) always have

C) always am have

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Cuándo se usa el present simple y cuándo el continuous; Cómo se forma la tercera persona con -s, -es, -ies; Cómo se hacen negativas y preguntas con do/does y am/is/are; Qué palabras de tiempo acompañan a cada presente.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

Present simple

Rutinas y verdades: I play, she plays.

-es / -ies

watches, goes · studies, flies.

don't / doesn't

Negativa del present simple.

Do / Does...?

Preguntas del present simple.

Present continuous

Ahora: am / is / are + -ing.

swimming, writing

Doblar consonante · quitar la e.

always ... never

Adverbios de frecuencia, antes del verbo.

like, know, want

No suelen ir en continuo.

Soluciones

1. **B)** He/she/it + -s; go → goes.
2. **C)** Look! = ahora.
3. **A)** Se dobla la n.
4. **C)** Pregunta con you: Do.
5. **B)** He + doesn't.
6. **A)** Indica ahora.
7. **B)** Know no va en continuo.
8. **C)** Consonante + y → -ies.
9. **A)** They + are + -ing.
10. **B)** Antes del verbo principal.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. goes, flies, washes, has.
2. writing, swimming, playing, sitting.
3. Tom doesn't like carrots.
4. Do they live in Seville?
5. is climbing.
6. have.
7. I am never late.
8. She knows the answer.
9. I usually go by bike, but today I'm walking.
10. Model answer: I play basketball on Tuesdays. Now I'm doing my English homework.